

1. What did you accomplish this week?

I got the project notebook set up and loaded in the dataset. From there I cleaned the data and started running analysis: funding trends over time, breaking down by category, looking at which institutions and states get the most funding, and who the top pi are each year. I also looked at award durations and started working on the topic modeling part with LDA and BERTopic on the abstracts.

2. Did you learn or discover anything new?

The biggest thing I noticed is that NSF CSE funding peaked in 2023 at around \$670M and has been dropping since, 2024 and 2025 are both noticeably lower. I'm not sure exactly why but it could be related to federal budget changes. I also found that most awards last about 3 years which makes sense given how NSF grants typically work.

Also 2020 and 2026 are not complete data years, I am considering about deleting them for the dataset.

3. Are you uncertain, stuck, or worried about anything?

I spent a lot of time this week dealing with environment and setup issues in VS Code which slowed me down more than I expected. I'm also still working through the topic modeling section and not totally sure yet how to interpret the LDA results.

4. What is your plan for next week?

Finish up the topic modeling and get the notebook cleaned up.

5. Anything else?

No, I think I'm on track overall.